INDIANA STRATEGIC SITES INVENTORY (SSI) PROGRAM · DECISION BRIEF

# The case for reinvesting in SSI

Indiana owns the most complete greenfield site inventory in the nation: 1,811 sites discovered and ranked across all 92 counties. It cannot yet be fully leveraged, because due diligence, site control, and graduation to market are unfunded. Competing states now spend hundreds of millions to build what Indiana already owns.

SSI PROGRAM

INDIANA ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION

Strategic Sites Inventory · November 2026

**#1**
site elimination factor in 2026: availability of development-ready sites (61% of site selectors)

**76%**
of site selectors name development-ready site availability a top factor shaping the industry

**+20 pts**
year-over-year jump in the weight of site readiness and due diligence status (Area Development 2026)

**27+**
states now fund site readiness, "a national arms race in site preparation funding"

## WHAT OTHER STATES ARE PAYING TO BUILD




Committed site readiness funding since 2022, in millions. Ohio awarded $350M of a $750M fund to 11 sites and cut the rest in July 2025; JobsOhio adds $250M through 2030. Most of it buys the identification and tiering Indiana completed for $1.39M.

## WHAT INDIANA ALREADY OWNS

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sites identified, all 92 counties | 1,811 | Acres identified | 235,402 |
| Counties locally reviewed | 74 | Sites ranked 4.0 or higher | 490 |
| Sites ranked 5.0 | 141 | Potential mega sites | 70 |
| Solar sites (10,142 MW) | 38 | Hyperscale data center candidates | 58 |

**Proof at the highest level: LEAP**
IEDC markets the 9,000-acre LEAP Research and Innovation District as sitting "all on an SSI-certified (Strategic Site Inventory) site." The SSI team supported LEAP in 2021 and delivered the Boone County 3,099-acre Technology MegaSite in 2022. Eli Lilly has since committed $18 billion and Meta $10 billion there.

## THE COST OF STANDING STILL

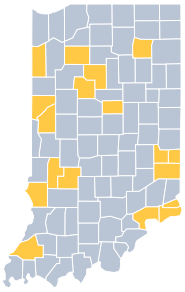
**Inventory decay**
Phase I data dates from 2018 to 2021. Ownership, zoning, solar conversion and data center absorption change conditions every year; rescreening stopped in 2024.

**Lost projects**
Site readiness is now the first screen. An unadvanced site fails it quietly and the state never learns it lost. One mid-size plant exceeds this whole program's cost.

**Partner momentum**
Eight utilities and 92 LEDOs organized budgets and calendars around SSI. Phase II slowed when IEDC's budget ran out in July 2024; a cold restart costs more than continuity.

**Portal goes dark**
IEDC called the SSI Portal "mission critical" for RFI response. Licenses lapsed June 2025; the system of record for 1,811 sites is unavailable to the people who answer prospects.

## THE UNFINISHED JOB



**18 counties never reviewed.** Carroll, Cass, Clay, Fayette, Fountain, Franklin, Gibson, Jefferson, Newton, Ohio, Owen, Pulaski, Sullivan, Switzerland, Tipton, Union, Warren, Whitley.

**9 of 490** top-ranked sites have Phase II due diligence. **0** have graduated to market under site control. Phase III costs $10,000 to $25,000 per site and requires no land purchase.

## THE ASK: A THREE-YEAR INDIANA SSI SITE GRADUATION PROGRAM, EIGHT TRACKS ACROSS THE SSI PHASES

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| A | **Complete and refresh the inventory (Phase I)**<br>18 remaining county workshops; rescreen 490 ranked sites | TBD | IEDC |
| F | **Data center model for smaller sites (Phase I)**<br>25 to 150 acre sites on existing substation and fiber capacity; all 92 counties | TBD | IEDC, utilities |
| G | **Inactive Facility Revitalization for CIRDA (Phase I)**<br>Inventory and rank idle industrial and commercial facilities, ten counties | TBD | IEDC, CIRDA |
| H | **SSI: Community for CIRDA (Phase I)**<br>Neighborhood-level areas of opportunity in distressed communities; Catalyze plan | TBD | IEDC, CIRDA, READI |
| B | **Phase II due diligence**<br>36 top-ranked sites, 12 per year, weighted to life sciences, pharma, defense | TBD | IEDC 50% / utilities 50% |
| C | **Site advancement for the REDOs and LEDOs (Phase III)**<br>Landowner engagement, purchase options, zoning, publication: first 18 sites; REDO training | TBD | IEDC, LEDOs |
| D | **Target-industry technical marketing (Phase IV)**<br>NAICS-code all 490 sites ranked 4.0+; profiles and brochures for top 100 | TBD | IEDC 50% / utilities 50% |
| E | **SSI Portal and program management**<br>Portal licenses, RFI support, quarterly reporting | TBD | IEDC, utility licenses |

**TBD**
three-year budget and cost share, to be set in joint scoping with IEDC and the Power Partners

**$1.39M**
Indiana's entire seven-year SSI investment to date, against $600M committed in Ohio and $460M in Michigan

**18 sites**
graduated under purchase option by year three; 45 with Phase II; 490 NAICS-coded; CIRDA facility and community inventories delivered

## THEN TURN THE INVENTORY INTO AN OUTBOUND ENGINE: SSI: SIGNALS

**Ranked inventory**
490 sites at 4.0+ in the SSI Portal

**NAICS-coded sites**
Sector codes, acreage, utilities, labor shed

**SSI: Signals**
AI reads filings, permits, hiring for expansion intent

**Site-to-prospect match**
Leads matched to Indiana sites by NAICS and infrastructure

**Projects**
Outreach months before a consultant RFI arrives

## PARTNERS READY TO CO-INVEST

IEDC · Duke Energy Indiana · Wabash Valley Power Alliance · NIPSCO · Hoosier Energy · AES Indiana · CenterPoint Energy · I&M · IMPA · 92 LEDOs, 15 REDOs

Utilities funded Phase II at $10,000 per site and licensed portals through 2025; they followed IEDC into the pause and will follow IEDC out of it. **Four decisions requested:** authorize joint scoping of the eight tracks within 60 days; renew SSI Portal access now; introduce LDG to CIRDA leadership; receive a briefing at the President's convenience.


LOCATION Design Group · SSI PROGRAM

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Sources: Site Selectors Guild and DCI 2026 pulse check; Area Development Q1 2026; MEDC, JobsOhio, VEDP, Site Selection Group; IEDC LEAP and SSI pages; IEDC contracts and Leotta Location and Design (LL+D)/LDG invoices 2018 to 2025; companion Case for Reinvestment.